

Origin-driven caching is safer for APIs because the application explicitly controls which responses are allowed to be cached, instead of relying on fixed CDN rules. This reduces load on APIs that must serve millions of requests, such as mobile applications, while avoiding accidental caching of sensitive or user-specific data. For example, in a stock trading app, public data like market news or onboarding content can be safely cached, while account data or real-time prices can be marked as private or no-store so they are never cached. If an endpoint requires real-time accuracy, origin-driven caching ensures the CloudFront will not cache it unless the application explicitly allows it. If caching headers are missing, CloudFront defaults to not caching, which prioritizes data safety over performance.